Investor Meeting — Q&A Prep

Workit · Futhersky Solutions · for the 30 September 2026 meeting (Harambee network). Anticipated questions + crisp, honest answers.
«…» = confirm your own number/detail before the meeting.

The raise & the money

Q · How much are you raising, and at what valuation?

We're raising growth capital in the R100k–R500k range — R100k funds a lean 6-month runway to prove liquidity in the first suburbs; R500k funds 12 months, a first small team and payments. I'd rather anchor on the milestones the money buys than a headline valuation, and I'm open on terms for the right partner.

→ «Decide your target amount + a valuation range (or 'open, keen on your view') before the meeting.»

Q · What exactly does the money do, and by when?

The product is built and live, so this is go-to-market, not build risk. **Months 1–6:** demand generation in a few Gauteng suburbs, worker onboarding & verification ops, and the first youth hires. **From ~month 8** revenue starts coming in — a light service fee, then the flat R25/R50 subscription — and **by month 12** it's ramping, positioning us for a seed round. Every rand is tied to reaching local liquidity and the first paying transactions.

Q · What's your burn?

We run lean today — roughly R20,000–R25,000 a month, founder-led (hosting, comms, verification ops and a modest stipend). With this round it steps up to about R40,000 a month as we add youth hires and push demand. Even then it's a fraction of a VC-heavy competitor's burn, so breakeven needs far less volume.

→ «Adjust the R20k–25k / R40k figures to your actual cash-flow if they differ.»

Q · Unit economics — take rate, CAC, revenue timing?

Workit is free **for users** at launch — not free to run (that's the burn above), but free to them to build liquidity fast. Revenue begins around month 8: a flat R25/R50 monthly subscription as the core model, plus an optional small service fee — predictable, not per-transaction. Acquisition cost stays low via WhatsApp sharing, referrals and community ambassadors. These are planning assumptions until demand is live — proving them is what this phase funds.

Traction & demand (the honest weak spot — own it)

Q · You've got workers but almost no jobs. How do you know there's demand?

Straight answer: we deliberately built the platform and the supply side first — ~90 workers already signed up with almost no spend — so demand isn't proven on-platform yet. That's this phase. But the demand plainly exists: the entire informal-work economy runs on it today, offline via word-of-mouth. We've sourced 225 business leads and the pilot ran 7 jobs end-to-end. The real question isn't 'is there demand' — it's 'can we acquire it cheaply.'

Q · How do you get customers without burning years of cash, like SweepSouth and Kandua?

Four things they didn't combine: density-first (saturate a few suburbs, not thin national spread); low-CAC channels (WhatsApp, referrals, ambassadors); a B2B/SME wedge (recurring demand is cheaper and stickier than one-off consumers); and a radically lower burn so breakeven needs far less scale. Harambee's network could also be a demand pipeline.

Q · What's your single riskiest assumption?

Cheap demand acquisition. I won't pretend otherwise — the whole plan is built to de-risk it in one suburb before spending to scale.

Competition & defensibility

Q · Why won't Kandua or SweepSouth just copy you?

They're structurally committed to their models — Kandua to lead-gen + manual reference checks, SweepSouth to a managed cleaning vertical on commission. Going broad, trust-first and mass-market (low-data, cash-friendly) is a different company, not a feature they bolt on. See the attached comparison one-pager.

Q · What's your moat?

Three compounding things: local liquidity per suburb (two-sided network effects), accumulated trust data (verified IDs + rated job history + in-app proof-of-work), and a cost base that lets us serve the mass market profitably where premium players can't.

Team & execution

Q · It's mostly you — isn't that key-person risk?

Today it's me (product & tech) and Simphiwe (operations), run off a documented operating playbook so ops can be handed over. This round's first hires are **young South Africans to run and grow Workit alongside me** — which is the whole point: a youth-employment company that itself employs youth. It also deepens the natural fit with Harambee.

→ «Name any advisors/mentors, or the Harambee relationship, as extra de-risking support.»

Q · Can a small team run trust & safety at scale?

Yes, because it's automation-first — image scanning, text screening, rate-limits and auto-escalation do the heavy lifting; humans only handle exceptions. That's the cost advantage over the manual incumbent model.

Trust, safety, legal & regulatory

Q · What's your liability if a job goes wrong — theft, injury, a bad actor?

Mitigated by human ID verification, ratings, doorstep start-codes, live location, an SOS button, photo evidence and admin dispute review. Our terms position Workit as a facilitator, not the employer, allocating risk between the parties. Job insurance via a partner is on the roadmap.

Q · Are workers employees? Any labour-law exposure?

Workers are independent — Workit connects them with employers and payment is direct between the parties; there's no employment relationship. It's the standard gig-marketplace model, and we keep legal counsel close as we scale.

Q · POPIA / data protection?

Built in — consent-gated analytics, data export & erasure, a private-document split for sensitive data, and enforced admin two-factor auth. Attorney sign-off and Information Officer registration are budgeted and in progress.

Payments & monetisation

Q · Payment is cash/EFT off-platform — how do you earn, and won't people just bypass you?

It's free **for users** while we build liquidity — but not free to run; we carry the hosting, comms and verification costs (our burn). Then we monetise with a flat R25/R50 monthly subscription, not a per-job cut — which also removes the incentive to transact around us (you don't save by going off-platform). What keeps people on: discovering NEW vetted people, reputation, and recourse if something goes wrong. Repeat off-platform relationships are fine and expected — we monetise the discovery + trust layer.

Harambee partnership & the ask

Q · What do you actually want from us at this stage?

The most valuable thing isn't a cheque — it's a **funded pilot partnership**. Harambee channels youth work-seekers from your network into Workit in one or two Gauteng suburbs; we run a 3–6 month pilot together; and we report the outcomes your programmes value — youth placed into earning, jobs done, rand earned. That solves our single hardest problem (cheap demand + a supply pipeline) and fits your outcomes/donor funding. Alongside it: warm introductions to funders or corporates in your network. If capital is on the table, a modest R100k to run the pilot, tied to clear milestones.

→ «Confirm the suburb(s) + the milestone numbers you'd commit to (e.g. first N paying jobs / N active earners in 6 months).»

Q · What do the next 6–12 months look like?

Density across 3–10 Gauteng suburbs, first paying transactions, payments/escrow, the first youth hires, and WhatsApp/SMS notifications — positioned for a seed round.

Golden rule for the room: on demand/traction, lead with candour — 'supply and product are built; cheap demand is the unknown we're funding.' Sherrie respects honesty far more than spin. And lead the ask with the pilot, not the cheque.